

HANDS-FREE GOLF CADDIE

AI Caddie & Scorekeeper

A complete summary of what the app does, and how to use every part of it
on the course and at home.

User Guide

September 2026

1. What the app is

AI Caddie & Scorekeeper is a phone-based golf caddie. It lives in the browser (best in Chrome on Android) and can be saved to the Home Screen like an app. It watches GPS, looks up wind and elevation, picks a club, talks you through a sensible plan for the hole, and keeps score by voice or tap.

It is built for a real round: pockets, Bluetooth earbuds, and as little tapping as possible. It knows the difference between being at home and being on a golf course, so it will not nag you to mark a pin in the kitchen.

What it does well

- **Finds you.** GPS decides whether you are off-course or on a mapped golf course.
- **Aims at the green.** On a mapped course it reads holes and greens from OpenStreetMap and targets the current green automatically.
- **Gives a plays-like number.** Raw GPS yards are adjusted for elevation, wind, and your recent distance misses.
- **Recommends a club** from your bag, then a strategy for that shot.
- **Manages the hole like a caddie.** Handicap, par, and mapped bunkers or water change the advice: club down on short par 4s, lay up on long par 5s, extra club over trouble, miss to the fat of the green.
- **Talks like a caddie.** Australian male voice when the phone has one, and it uses your name (default Kerry).
- **Keeps score** hole by hole, including undo, skip, and finish round. Rounds survive a refresh and finished cards sit in Round History.
- **Learns your miss.** Saying you came up short, flew long, missed left or right nudges yardages and aim.

What it is not

It is not a laser rangefinder, a full course CAD package, or a Tour caddie with every bunker book. Greens are mapped as the middle of the putting surface unless you override the pin. Hazards only appear when OpenStreetMap has them. Club distances start as a generic bag until you train them. Use it as a smart yardage and strategy partner, then trust your eyes on anything it cannot see.

2. First-time setup

Do this once at home, with a few minutes and a decent signal. It pays off on the first tee.

Install it on the phone

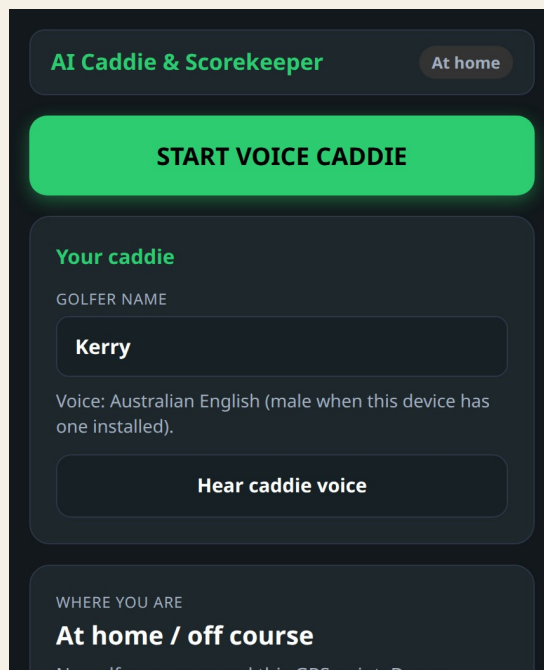
- Open the app in **Chrome on Android** if you can. Voice listening is strongest there. Safari on iPhone will still keep score with buttons; continuous listening is limited.
- Allow **Location** when asked. High-accuracy GPS is how yardage and course detection work.
- Allow the **microphone** only if you want hands-free commands.
- Add to Home Screen (Chrome menu → Add to Home screen / Install app) so it opens full screen like a native app.
- After an update, force-close and reopen, or pull to refresh, so you are not stuck on an old cached copy.

Australian male voice

The caddie asks the phone for an English (Australia) male voice. If the phone only has a US or UK voice, you will still hear Australian English phrasing, but the accent will be whatever is installed.

- **Android:** Settings → System → Languages → Text-to-speech. Install **English (Australia)** and pick a male voice if the engine offers one.

- **iPhone:** Settings → Accessibility → Spoken Content → Voices → English. Download **Lee** (male, Australia). Karen is Australian but female.
- Back in the app, tap **Hear caddie voice**. You should hear “G'day Kerry...” (or your name).



Your caddie card: name, handicap, play style, and a voice preview.

Tell it who you are

- **Golfer name** defaults to Kerry. Change it in the field, or say “call me Kerry”.
- **Handicap** defaults to 14. Set your real number. This is not vanity — it changes strategy.
- Handicap 0–8: more aggressive when the shot is on. 9–18: play smart (club down, lay up, fat of the green). 19+: protect the double.
- You can also say “handicap 14”.

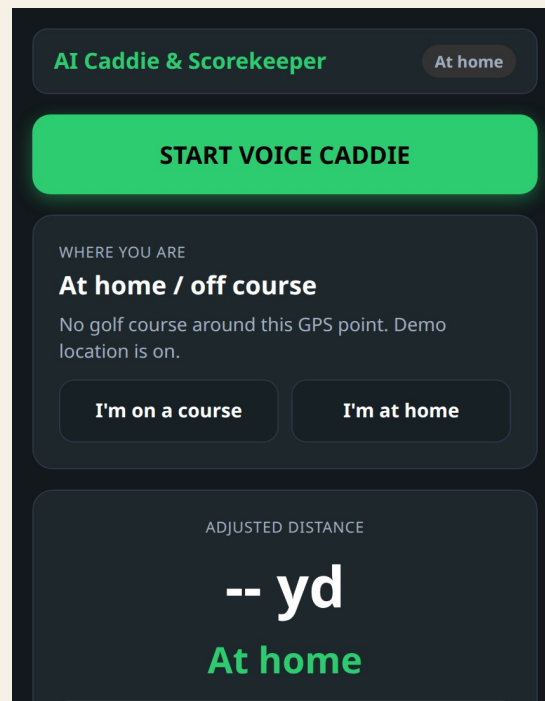
Why handicap matters. A 14-handicap on a 273-yard par 4 should hear “5-wood, leave a wedge,” not “hit driver at the flag.” A 5-handicap can take more risk. Put in the number you actually play to.

3. Home versus the course

After GPS settles, the Where you are card is the truth. Read it before you start hunting for a pin.

At home / off course

If OpenStreetMap does not see a golf course around you, the app stays in scorekeeper mode. The big number stays blank, Laser GPS says Off course, and the pin button is **Drop practice pin** — optional, for backyard testing only. You can still add strokes, preview the voice, and review history. It will not demand a pin.



Off-course view. Scorekeeping works; pin setup stays out of the way.

On a mapped course

When GPS is on a tagged golf course, the card shows the course name, a hole strip (1–18 if mapped), and the app aims at that hole's green. Walk to your ball; the plays-like number and club update. Tap a hole number if it guessed the wrong one, or say "hole 7".

On an unmapped course

Some courses are not in OpenStreetMap hole-by-hole. Tap **I'm on a course** (or say it). Then stand on the green and tap **Mark Pin Here** / say "mark pin". Walk back to the ball for yardage. Repeat on each green. If the app thinks you are on a course when you are in the driveway, tap **I'm at home**.

Teaching a missing hole

Totteridge and other local tracks may be missing a few holes on the public map. Dashed hole numbers are the gaps. On that tee, tap **Save tee here** (or say "save tee"). On the green, **Mark Pin Here**. The phone keeps those points. Next round the caddie aims from the tee without waiting on OpenStreetMap. This stays on the device; it is not uploaded.

4. How to play a round

This is the full loop. Do it in this order and the rest of the app falls into place.

- 1. First tee.** Open the app, confirm the course name, check hole 1 and par. Allow GPS to settle for a few seconds while you stand still.
- 2. Start the caddie.** Tap **Start Voice Caddie** if you want earbuds. You should hear a greeting with your name. Keep the screen awake; the app requests a wake lock.
- 3. Tee shot.** If you are on the tee of a mapped hole, you will already have a number and a plan (for example club down on a short par 4). Say "okay caddie" or tap **Ask Caddie**.
- 4. Hit, then log.** After the swing, say "add stroke" / "count shot" or tap **Add Stroke**. Do this for every swing including penalties you want on the card. **Undo Stroke** if you double-tapped.

5. Walk to the ball. Stand still over the ball. The GPS and plays-like figures update. Ask again. The plan changes from tee-shot advice to approach or lay-up advice.

6. Green and pin. Mapped greens are the centre. If the pin is tucked or the map is off, walk to the flag and **Mark Pin Here**. Then walk back.

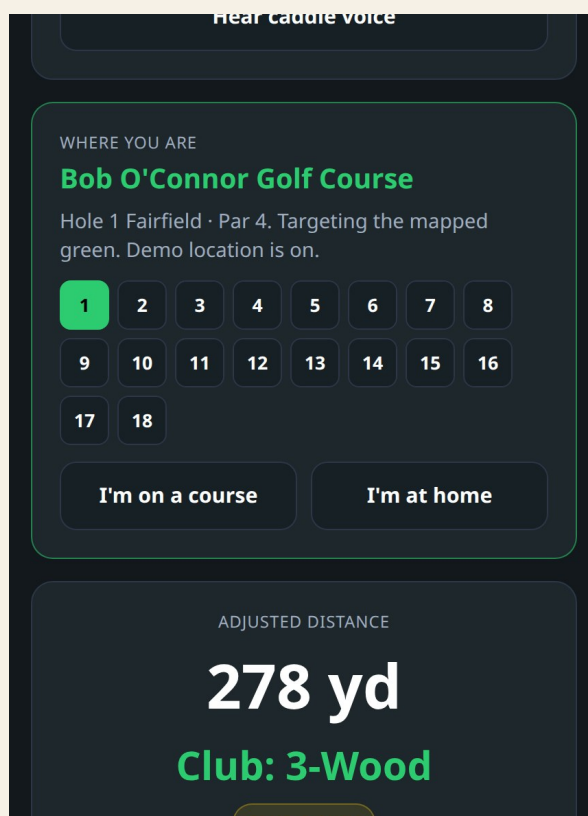
7. Finish the hole. When the ball is in, say “next hole” / “finish hole” or tap **Next Hole**. It stores par and strokes, then aims at the next green. Use **Skip Hole** only if you did not play it.

8. Finish the round. Say “finish round” or tap **Finish Round**. The current hole is included if it has strokes. A card is written to Round History and the scorecard resets.

Golden rule. Count the stroke after you hit, then walk, then ask. If you ask from the tee after you have already played, the advice will still sound like a tee shot. Keep the scorecard honest and the strategy stays honest.

5. Reading the numbers

- **Adjusted distance (plays-like)** is the number to club. It is GPS yards plus elevation, wind along your line, and a small personal distance bias.
- **Laser GPS** is the raw map distance to the current target (green or marked pin).
- **Elevation impact** — uphill plays longer, downhill shorter.
- **Wind velocity** is speed and direction. Headwind/tailwind is already folded into plays-like.
- **Club** is the bag club whose stock distance best matches the *intended shot*, not always the remaining yards to the flag (a 400-yard par 5 does not mean “hit driver at the green”).
- **Play plan** is the strategy label: Play smart, Club down, Lay up, Attack when it’s on, Protect the double.
- **Shot shape bias** moves from Neutral toward Fade/Slice or Draw/Hook as you log left and right misses.



On a short par 4 at handicap 14: 5-wood, club down, leave a full wedge.

6. Course strategy, used properly

The caddie is trying to save doubles, not paint flags. It uses your handicap, the hole's par, whether you are on the tee, remaining yards, and any bunkers or water mapped near that hole.

How it thinks

- **Short par 4s (typical 14-handicap):** 5-wood or 7-wood off the tee, wedge in. Driver can run through.
- **Par 3s:** fat of the green is a good 3. Extra club if trouble is short.
- **Par 5s:** fairway first. If the green is not on in two for your bag, it lays up to about a full wedge (~110 yards) instead of recommending driver at a 280-yard green.
- **Approaches:** extra club for mid- and high-handicaps (amateurs miss short). Aim the middle. If a bunker or water sits short, take more club and miss long or centre.
- **Low handicaps (0–8):** more licence to attack when the number is in scoring range, still missing on the fat side.
- **Your miss:** a stored fade starts you left of the safe line; a draw starts you right.

Mapped hazards come from OpenStreetMap (bunkers, water hazards, ponds). If a hole is not mapped, you still get par- and handicap-based advice, but not “water is short.” If you can see trouble the map missed, play the trouble you can see.

7. Scorekeeping

Every hole needs a par and a stroke count. Default par is 4 until you set it. On mapped holes, par comes from the course data when you land on that hole.

- Set par with “par 3 / 4 / 5” or it will already be filled on a mapped hole.
- **Add Stroke** after every shot you want on the card.
- **Next Hole** refuses to advance if there are zero strokes (use Skip Hole if you walked it).
- **Finish Round** saves a history card with date, holes played, and score to par. In-progress rounds survive closing the tab.
- Relative score (E, +3, –1) includes the current hole only after you have started it.

8. Training your bag

The stock bag is Kerry's: driver 220, 5-wood 210, 7-wood 200, 3-hybrid 190, then irons and wedges. “Came up short” / “flew long” still tune those numbers after real shots.

- After a shot with the recommended club, say “**came up short**” or “**flew long**”. That club's number moves two yards and a small distance bias is stored.
- “**Missed left**” / “**pulled it**” and “**missed right**” / “**pushed it**” build a fade or draw bias used in aim advice.
- “**Good shot**” / “**hit green**” logs a hit and adds a stroke.
- Be honest and consistent. A handful of real misses is more useful than tapping at random on the couch.

9. Voice command reference

Speak naturally; the app matches phrases inside what it heard. Wait until it finishes talking before the next command, or it can hear itself. Tap **Stop Voice Caddie** when you are in the car.

Say this	What happens
“Okay caddie”, “distance”, “what club”	Plays-like number, club, and strategy.
“Mark pin”, “that’s the pin”	Saves GPS as the target. On a missing green, this is remembered for next round.
“Save tee”, “that’s the tee”	Saves this tee for the current hole on this phone.
“Hole 7”	Jumps to that mapped hole and its green. Saves the previous hole if it already had strokes.
“Where am I?”, “what course”	Home versus course name and hole.
“I’m at home” / “I’m on a course”	Overrides GPS if the map is wrong.
“Call me Kerry”	Sets the name used in conversation.
“Handicap 14”	Sets handicap and play style.
“Par 3 / 4 / 5”	Sets the current hole’s par.
“Add stroke”, “count shot”	Adds one stroke.
“Undo stroke”	Removes the last stroke on this hole.
“Next hole”, “finish hole”	Stores the hole and advances.
“Skip hole”	Advances without storing strokes.
“What’s my score?”	Hole, strokes, and score to par.
“Finish round”, “save round”	Writes Round History and resets.
“Good shot”, “hit green”	Hit logged and a stroke added.
“Came up short” / “flew long”	Tunes that club’s yardage.
“Missed left” / “missed right”	Updates fade/draw bias.

Every voice command has a button except the small talk (“where am I”, “call me...”, miss logging). If the wind is up or Chrome is moody, play the round on buttons and you lose nothing that matters.

10. How to get everything out of it

- Stand still for two seconds before you ask. GPS jumps while you walk.
- Ask from the ball, not from the bag cart twenty metres away.
- Set the real handicap before the round, not after the 7th hole.
- On mapped courses, glance at the hole strip. If you are on 12 and it still says 1, tap 12.
- Override the pin when the flag is tucked or the green map is clearly the wrong blob.
- Log every stroke, including the duffed chip. Strategy assumes the count is true.
- Use earbuds so you can hear the plan without staring at the screen in sunlight.
- After we ship an update, reopen the installed app so the new service worker loads.
- Practice pin at home is only for testing GPS. Leave it unused unless you are debugging.

11. If something looks wrong

If you see this	Try this
Still asking to mark a pin at home	Force-refresh or reopen the Home Screen app so you are not on an old version. Confirm Location is on. Tap I'm at home if you live next to a course.
US or female voice	Install English (Australia) TTS. On iPhone download Lee. Tap Hear caddie voice again.
No course name on the first tee	Wait for GPS. If the course is unmapped, tap I'm on a course. Teach missing holes with Save tee and Mark pin.
Yardage is hundreds of yards off	Wrong hole is selected, or an old pin is still stored. Tap the correct hole, or mark pin from the green you are actually playing.
Voice stops listening	It pauses while it talks. If it dies, Stop then Start Voice Caddie. Chrome on Android is the reliable listener.
iPhone will not listen continuously	Use the Round Controls buttons. Score, strategy, and GPS still work.
Wind or elevation shows dashes	No signal to Open-Meteo. Raw GPS yards still work; club from Laser GPS until data returns.

12. Data, cost, and honesty

There is no subscription and no API key in the app. Location, voice, and score live on the phone. Course maps come from public OpenStreetMap Overpass servers. Wind and elevation come from Open-Meteo (free for personal use). The only cost is ordinary mobile data if you are not on Wi-Fi.

OpenStreetMap is volunteer cartography. A municipal course may have perfect greens; a private track may only have an outline. Teach the gaps on the round: Save tee, then Mark pin. Those points stay on the phone for next time. The caddie will still keep score either way.

On the first tee, in one line. Confirm the course and hole, set handicap, start voice if you want it, ask for a club, hit, add a stroke, walk, ask again, finish the hole. Do that eighteen times. That is the whole app.